ARK NOVA

PLAY BY PLAY

GUIDE

This guide will serve as a detailed and illustrated example of how to play the game. It can be used as a step by step reading to a first game for new players or you may use it to learn how to play and teach your fellow players basic concepts.

For your first game the existing Ark Nova Starting Decks show some starting cards and give a few pointers for the first actions. That resource is intended to help players play a smoother first game by streamlining the starting hand selection and giving them good cards to have a succesful and strategic first game to play. Being familiar with both documents will help you share the game and race to victory.

You can access the **Ark Nova Starting Decks** document here

Starting Setup







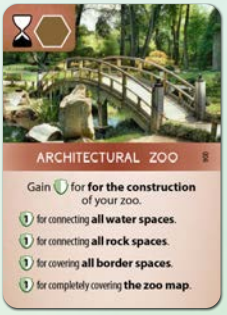
Dr. Penelope Cooper has been charged with developing a zoo in Charlotte, North Carolina. With a population of over 700,000 people, Charlotte is one of the largest American cities without a major zoo. **Dr. Cooper** aims to change that! To do so, though, she needs to focus if the zoo is going to be a success.

Looking at her options, she decides to try to start the zoo around the **Waza Small Animals Program**, a Sponsor Card that will allow her to grow her program quickly, as long as she has the animals and enclosures available to do so. **Dr. Cooper** keeps the **Water Playground** because she hopes to make use of its Appeal without building an enclosure . She's been forced to discard several animals that would have fit well in her zoo, like the **Stoat** and the **Pygmy Hippopotamus**. She elected to keep the **Great Hornbill** instead, as it helps meet the prominent **Birds** conservation goal. Her final card is the **Science Library** – a Sponsor card that will allow her to take advantage of any research **Professor Adebayo** undertakes at his zoo. It also has an end game goal for **Dr. Cooper** to work towards, so she's all set.





















Professor Tifeoluwa Adebayo has been charged with rehabilitating an area in Calabar, Nigera. It had a brief stint as a zoo in the 1970s, when **Professor Adebayo** was a child, and he dreams of restoring the area to its former glory. Keeping all of his choices in mind, he forms a vision of a water-based zoo while considering the important conservation efforts he wants the zoo to support.



He puts hiring a **Hydrologist** high on his priority list and notes that he already has offers to house several animals from the Americas, each of which will assist with other worldwide conservation efforts. He chooses to work on housing a **Greater Rhea**, an **Anaconda**, and a **Brown Spider Monkey** – all from the Americas. With one being a Bird and another being a Primate, **Professor Adebayo** feels well on his way to supporting global conservation efforts. He would have liked to try to bring the **New Zealand Sea Lion** to the zoo to support his dream, but he has to be smart about how realistic that would be in the zoo's infancy!















With the announcement of two developing sites in the US and Nigeria, the worldwide community rushes to offer services and partnerships while Dr. Cooper and Professor Adebeyo begin their monumental task of curating their zoos.

Dr. Cooper is somewhat interested in the **South American Coati**, as it is a small animal, but the other offers are not as exciting to her. She is going to have to do some digging on her own.

Professor Adebayo, on the other hand, is immediately drawn to the coalition calling for more **Aquatic** conservation efforts as it perfectly aligns with his vision for the Calabar Zoo.

Turn 1

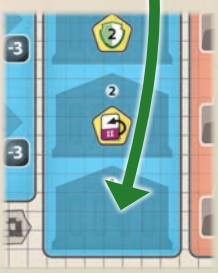


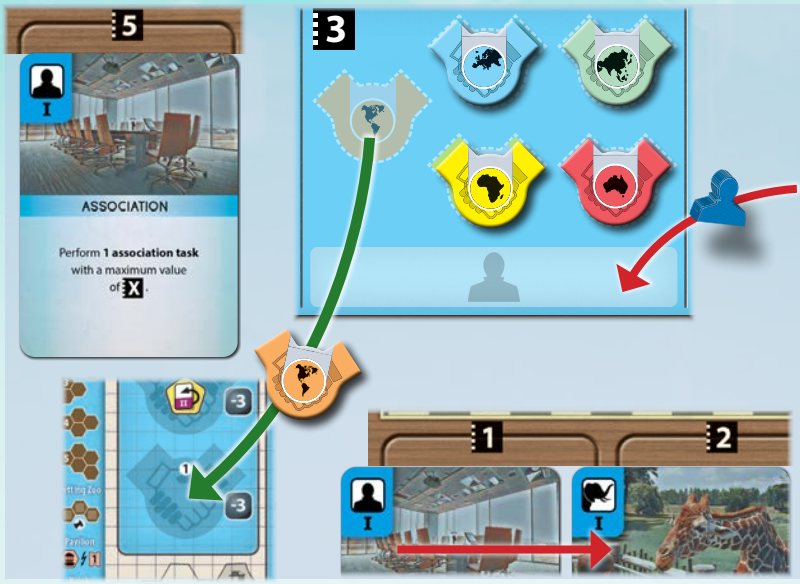
With her mind set on starting up the **Waza Small Animals Program**, Dr. Cooper activates the **Association I** card on her first turn. As it was in the fourth card slot on her board, she can place her Associate pawn anywhere on the Association board except in the 5 strength space. She doesn't have any Conservation Cards to play, so she places it on the **University space** and chooses to associate with a **University** that grants her zoo **2 Reputation**, bringing it to a total of **3** – exactly what she needs to start the **Waza Small Animals Program**!













Professor Adebayo follows suit, activating his **Association I** card as well; it's in his fifth Initiative slot, but he can't take advantage of that. He needs to develop a partnership with an established zoo in the Americas. This will help him out immensely as it reduces his cost to house animals from the Americas and he has three lined up for his zoo!

Luckily Dr. Cooper was not interested in the same partnership, as there is only one zoo from each continental area willing to partner at each time and if she were to swipe that from under his nose, all of his plans would be for nought. This also pushes his **Animal I** card into the second card slot, where it can actually be used.

Turn 2



First to break ground, Dr. Cooper uses her **Build I** card from the card 3 slot and orders a **2-space Enclosure** be built. She already has a 3-space Enclosure that the zoo started with, but she's planning ahead: the **Waza Small Animals program** allows her to house many animals in one action!

She also wants to be smart with the money entrusted to her, so she doesn't want to build something bigger, even though she could have – she plans on keeping the size of the animals she brings in to be size 2 or smaller, for the most part. Dr. Cooper signs the purchase order for **$4**, leaving her with **$21**.

Because she built in that specific location, Dr. Cooper also gains **1 X-token**. She holds that in reserve for future actions!







Professor Adebayo wants to try to give more incentive for hiring a **Hydrologist**, so he brings in one new animal by activating his **Animal I** card from the second card slot. His first exhibit? An Anaconda from the Americas!

While Dr. Cooper is just starting out, the Constriction effect from the Anaconda cannot target her, but Professor Adebayo feels that he can't wait just to be petty! He pays **$10** despite the $13 normally required. This is due to forming a partnership with the zoo in the Americas, reducing his costs significantly! He now has **$15** left instead of the $12 he could have had. With the addition of the Anaconda, the zoo gains **6 Appeal**. Professor Adebayo scores first! He flips over the **3-space enclosure** the zoo started with and welcome's the zoo's first resident. This is only a legal enclosure because it is next to water, otherwise the Anaconda could not be enclosed there.

Turn 3



This is the turn that she's set up for. Now that the Charlotte Zoo has at least **3 Reputation**, Dr. Cooper activates the **Sponsor I** card from the fifth card slot, and starts the **Waza Small Animals Program**. This Program allows her to house more small animals (Size 2 or under) at once and gain more possible exhibits of similar type. Had she had some small animals in the zoo already, she would have gained **$2** for each such animal, but she did not plan for that specifically. You can't make everything happen all of the time! Sometimes, you just need to decide one way or the other. Given that she had started with a decent amount of money, Dr. Cooper felt it was more important to start the program up quickly than to try to earn funds from it.







With the **Anaconda** happily making the trip from Brazil to Nigeria, Professor Adebayo thinks that it's time to hire the **Hydrologist** that will help him create the zoo of his dreams. Activating the **Sponsor I** card from the fifth card slot, the good Professor calls **Dr. Ijeoma Adesina**, a fellow Nigerian and an expert on the Cross River Basin, to offer her a position at the Calabar Zoo. **Dr. Adesina** readily accepts and, upon arrival, she suggests some changes to the **Anaconda's** enclosure to ensure that the artificial water feature will not negatively impact the natural hydrology of the area. Not only did her changes make better sense ecologically, it made for a more Appealing exhibit. The zoo gains **2 Appeal** for a total of **9**. With that, Professor Adebyo knows he hired the right person for the job!

Turn 4



Once again, Dr. Cooper elects to activate her **Build I** card. This time, because she has her eyes on a certain placement bonus, she orders a **1-space Building** to be constructed. Strategically, she has a **Kiosk** built, covering the **2 Reputation** icon, thus increasing her Zoo's Reputation to a total of **5**. This allows her to **flip one of her Action cards** to its second, more powerful, side. After long consideration, Dr. Cooper decides to increase the effectiveness of her **Animals** card – it can now be used in the first card slot and, if used from the fifth slot, it will also add 1 Reputation to her zoo. Spending **$2** seems worth it for these gains! Dr. Cooper's coffers now sit at **$19**.







Without an empty Enclosure, the Calabar Zoo can't bring in more animals. Activating the **Build I** card from the fifth card slot allows Professor Adebayo to bring at least one more in before he takes a Break. Looking at his options, he decides to only build a **2-space Enclosure** though he could technically build a massive 5-space Enclosure with this Action. He pays **$4** for the enclosure, leaving him with **$11**.

He strategically builds it covering the **Gain Card from Reputation Range icon**. This allows him to take the Aquatic Conservation card from Dossier 1. Had he not taken it, it was going to fall on deaf ears and be discarded in the near future. Professor Adebayo could not allow that!

As a Dossier card was taken, the whole row shifts to the left to fill up any empty slots and a new card – the Common Wall Lizard – slides into the sixth slot.



Turn 5



Looking at her situation, Dr. Cooper wants to play animal cards, but her newly flipped **Animals II** card is in the fourth card slot. The Reputation Bonus only applies when it's activated with 5 or more strength. She could boost her effect using her X-token but chooses to be patient instead.

Dr. Cooper activates her **Cards I** card that is currently in the highly valued fifth card slot. With nothing in the Dossier row of value to her, Dr. Cooper choose to draw cards instead of snapping one from the Dossier row. She draws **3 cards** – Lesser Flamingo, Rock Monitor, and Predator Breeding Program – and discards one. Given that the Birds Conservation card is in play and both the Lesser Flamingo and the Rock Monitor are small animals, she discards the Predator Breeding Program.

She does not have any Predators in her hand and many of them are large animals, of which she isn't totally interested. Even though she has the Large Animal Zoo Goal card, it was contradictory to the Waza Small Animals Program card that she built her opening strategy around. Though she hasn't really tried to accomplish all of the subgoals on the Architechural Zoo Goal card, she might focus on that in the future. It requires her to connect similar landmarks (water, rocks), build next to all border spaces, and fill the entire zoo, if possible - no small task, but if anyone can do it, it's Dr. Penelope Cooper! This also moves the **Break token** up the track by **2**.







Professor Adebayo activates the **Animals I** card to play the Greater Rhea. He pays **$9** instead of the regular **$12** cost, again thankful that he had the foresight to partner with the **zoo in the Americas**, where the Greater Rhea is from. This leaves him with a scant $2! He also flips over the **2-space enclosure** to indicate that it's occupied. The addition of this flightless bird to the zoo raises its **Appeal** by **5**, bringing the total to **14**. Given it's running speed of up to 37 miles per hour, the Greater Rhea has an Ability that activates when it's played called "**Sprint**". This allows Professor Adebayo to **draw one Zoo card** from the deck. He draws the Common European Adder and shrugs, unsure what to do with that offer. He supposes that building a reptile house in the future wouldn't be amiss as he already has an Anaconda featured. For that, he'd need to upgrade his **Build** Action card.

Turn 6



Dr. Cooper is finally ready to bring in some animals. Activating the **Animals II** card from the fifth card slot gives the Charlotte Zoo an immediate increase of **1 Reputation**, bringing its total to **6**.

Dr. Cooper then plays the Lesser Flamingo in the **3-space enclosure** next to the water they require, flipping it over to show that it's occupied. She pays **$15**, leaving her total at **$4**. This increases the zoo's **Appeal** by **6** and Dr. Cooper can now be targeted by opponent's effects like Hypnotize and the aforementioned Constrict.

Using the Lesser Flamingo's "**Posturing**" ability also allows Dr. Cooper to immediately build a **Pavillion** or **Kiosk** for free. Sensing that she's in dire needs of funds, she opts for a **Pavilion** and places it covering the **$5 icon**, increasing her total to **$9** and immediately adding to the zoo's **Appeal** by **1** bringing the total to **7**. She would have liked to build a **Kiosk** there, but she cannot build a kiosk so close to another one as there must be **2 spaces between Kiosks**.

Despite this much needed injection of funds, Dr. Cooper cannot play another animal from her hand – the **Animals II** card allows her to play any two animals from her hand and the Waza Small Animals Program allows her to play another small animal from here hand. Instead, she uses the Waza Small Animals Program's other ability and takes the Common Wall Lizard, a low-cost animal to exhibit, from the Dossier row and adds it to her hand.



She draws a new Zoo card to replace it in the row. The Sponsor card **Aerial Cableway** is added to Dossier 6. That one will take some planning as it needs 6 Strength to put into play. Only someone with one or more X-tokens would be able to add it to their zoo, or with an upgraded Sponsors action card.







With very little left in the bank, **Professor Adebayo** needs some more information to forecast his decisions. He chooses to activate **Cards I** from the fifth card slot, allowing him to draw 3 Zoo cards and discard 1. He draws two **tigers** – the **Sumatran** and the **Siberian** and the **Primate Breeding Program** Conservation card. Lucky! He has both requirements to play and score the **Primate Breeding Program**, so he keeps that one. The **Sumatran Tiger** has a hefty price tag, but it has two Water icons which would synergize well with many of his other long term goals and Conservation efforts. It's an easy choice for him to discard the costly **Siberian Tiger**. He takes a sip from a cold glass of zobo and moves the **Break token** up by **2**.

Turn 7



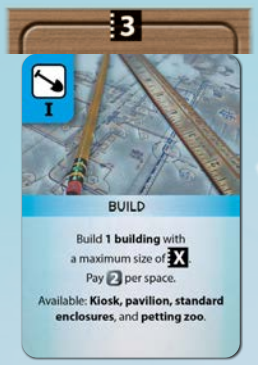
Animal II's power lies not only in its ability to give a Reputation boost at the highest Strength level but to be useful at the lowest! **Dr. Cooper** takes advantage of her upgraded Action and uses it from the first card slot to play the **Common Wall Lizard**, paying **$4** leaving her with **$5**. It adds **2 Appeal** to the zoo, for a total of **9**. She flips the **2-space enclosure** because it's next to the rocks that these lizards require. While she still can't take advantage of the **Waza Small Animals Program** ability to play another small animal directly, she uses its other ability again and takes the **South American Coati** from the Dossier row, which shifts to the left.

It now contains:

[1] **Expert in Large Animals**, **[2]** **Emu**, **[3]** **Okapi Stable**, **[4]** **Red Kangaroo**, **[5]** **Aerial Cableway**, **[6]** **Cheetah**.

The **Coati** is a small animal and could help **Dr. Cooper** meet the **Americas** Conservation effort, so it's worth taking in both regards.









Looking at his zoo, Professor Adebayo consults with **Dr. Adesina**. Together, the two notice that if they build something near the water, they can take advantage of the beauty of the natural landscape. With the last **$2** in the budget, Professor Adebayo activates the **Build I** action from the third card slot. He can only afford to pay for a **1-space building** though. He choses to build a 1-space Enclosure right next to the water as it will help him prepare for future exhibits, but it covers a **$5** icon and is next to water, gaining an additional **$1** with **Dr. Adesina's** input. The zoo now has **$6** remaining.

Turn 8



Dr. Cooper plays **Sponsors I** from the forth card slot. This allows her to add the **Science Library**, a Sponsor card that gives her **$2** everytime a Research icon is played into ANY zoo, even the one in Calabar! The zoo gains **$2** (because cards always count themselves and **Science Library** has one Research icon on in) for a total of **$6**. As an instant effect, the **Science Library** also gives **1 Appeal** for every **Research icon** in the zoo at the time of play. Since there are **2 Research icons** (one from the University Dr. Cooper associated with in Turn 1 and one from the **Science Library** itself), the zoo now has a total **Appeal** of **11**.











With not much else to do, Professor Adebayo draws another card from the deck and finds the **Indian Rhinoceros**. Most probably not a better card than what he already has, but the hand card limit is only checked during a break, not before.

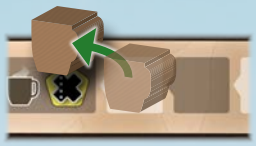
Turn 9



Dr. Cooper also has little resources left and is longing for a break. She uses her **Cards I** action again, which also moves the **Break token** up by **2**. She draws the **Broad-Snouted Caiman** and the **African Bush Elephant**. Not what she was hoping for, giving that they need large enclosures and a lot of money she does not currently has. She **discards** the **Elephant** and keeps the **Caiman** for now.







Heading home after a long day's work, Professor Adebayo activates **Sponsors I** from the forth card slot again, moving the **Break token** up by up to **4** spaces. 1 is enough to trigger the Break. He still gains **$4** and also **1 X-token**.



BREAK

During the Break, both players must discard down to 3 cards as neither of them has increased capacity due to University affiliation.



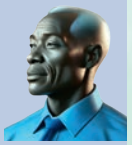
Dr. Cooper sadly discards the **South American Coati** as it would add the same amount of Appeal as the **Water Playground**, but it would also take the cost of building an enclosure while the **Water Playground** is essentially free. Alas! She also discards her recently acquired **Broad-Snouted Caiman** card with less reservation. She's committing to her decision to populate the zoo with small animals.







Professor Adebayo also has to make a tough decision. While the **Sumatran Tiger** would meet many criteria needed for his Conservation and End of Game Goals, it commands a princely sum to exhibit and the Professor has his eyes on making moves towards Conservation efforts this turn. He also discards the **Common European Adder**. It does not satisfy any of his needs, currently, so it is an easier card to get rid of.
As he had previously considered, he finally discards the **Indian Rhinoceros**. He already has more well-suited Conservation cards to focus on.



Luckily, Professor Adebayo was able to snatch the **Aquatic** Conservation card from the first Dossier as the first two cards are discarded from the Dossier Row at Break!



Everything shifts to the left as **Expert in Large Animals** and **Emu** are discarded to make space for **Gorilla Field Research** in Dossier 5 and **Grevy's Zebra** in Dossier 6.

During the final phase of the Break, Income, **Dr. Cooper** gains **$13** because her zoo is at **11 Appeal**. She also gains **$3** from the **two Kiosks** she has that are adjacent to inhabited enclosures. That brings her total funds to **$22**.



Professor Adebayo gains **$14** because his zoo is at **14 Appeal**. His single Kiosk earns the zoo **$2**, bringing his total, remarkably, to **$22** as well.



As **Professor Adebayo** triggered the break, **Dr. Cooper** will take her turn next.

What do you think their next moves should be? What does **Dr. Cooper** want to do? What should **Professor Adebayo** focus on?



Dr. Cooper may want to build some more small enclosures and increase her zoo's Reputation to 8 so she can have access to an additional Associate and partner with another zoo. This would allow her to take full advantage of the abilities her Animals II upgrade and the Waza Small Animals Program provide. It could also take a gamble on building a Petting Zoo in advance. She is not close to any of the Conservation goals that are visible to her, but that shouldn't stop her from trying! The upgrades are definitely worthwhile.



Professor Adebayo may want to start completing the Conservation goals he had his eyes on so he can remove cubes from the left side of his player board and gain access to some of the instant upgrades there. He is very close to a few of them already! From there, he may benefit from using the Hydrologist's added income for the benefit of the zoo.

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